

About Books and Alumnus

From Yufei Tang (yt9u23) <yt9u23@southamptonalumni.ac.uk>
Date Tue 9/10/2024 05:01
To libenqs (libenqs) <libenqs@soton.ac.uk>

Dear Officer,
My name is Yufei Tang, my student number is 35450142. I am a master student in Electronic Engineering. This letter is a letter of recommendation, and the content of the recommendations includes two aspects. The first aspect is about the construction of the existing library's book collection, and the second aspect is about the alumni and the construction of the library's book collection.

Mobile radio communications: second and third generation cellular and WATM systems

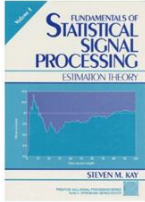
Book - by Raymond Steele; Lajos Hanzo - 1999 - 2nd ed - Additional [VIEW AVAILABILITY](#)

Library availability	Details
Hartley Library (Main Collection (Standard Loan)) - TK5103.2 STE 3 OF 3 COPIES AVAILABLE	Authors Raymond Steele
Library Store (Library Use Only) - stack S.U. Theses 2004 1 COPY AVAILABLE	Published date
View other formats/editions	Publisher
	Pub place Chiches
	Edition
Alternative availability	ISBN 047197806X, 97
Amazon £267.42	
Perlego UNAVAILABLE	

Let's start with the first aspect. Recently, I've been organizing the courses I studied during my master's program. One of the aspects I'm organizing is the reading list recommended by the course teacher. I'm very pleased that it's now very easy to quickly access the required materials for this course using the reading lists established by the library for each discipline. However, I believe there is still space for improvement, as shown in the following example. The image below shows the borrowing information for the book 'Mobile Radio Communications: Second and Third Generation Cellular and WATM Systems' as displayed in the reading list:

As shown in the above image, the book can be borrowed as a printed copy from the school library. However, the electronic version of this book is also available for free through the appropriate channels. This book can already be downloaded for free from IEEE, but the library has overlooked this important channel for the electronic version. This is just one example, and there are many similar cases. I hope the relevant library personnel can pay attention to this aspect, as it will greatly benefit the improvement of the library's quality.

Now let's discuss the second aspect. I believe the University of Southampton could pioneer this experiment. Although the library now allows quick access to the reading lists for the courses taken, a significant number of books are still shown as unavailable for borrowing, whether in electronic or printed form. This greatly hinders the interest of students who are keen to delve into this subject. Many of these books are very important, but students have to purchase them, and some of them are very expensive, such as the following books, which cost over a hundred pounds:



Fundamentals of statistical signal processing: estimation theory

Book - by Steven M. Kay - 1993 - Additional

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Library availability

Hartley Library (Main Collection (Standard Loan)) - TK5102.S5 KAY Vol.1

[NO COPIES HELD](#)

[View other formats/editions](#)

Alternative availability

Amazon [£105.96](#)

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Details

Authors	Steven M. Kay
Published date	1993
Publisher	PTR Prentice-Hall
Pub place	Englewood Cliffs, N.J.
ISBN	0133457117, 9780133457117

I know the library can initiate requests for some books, but based on my previous requests, the result was that I could only read parts of the book in electronic form. I think this result is disappointing. So, can we try to achieve something that no university in the world has done before? Turning all the books on the reading list into ones that students can freely view and borrow, I think it is possible. But how to handle the funding for this part? I think it can be built by charging an annual fee to alumni. Naturally, every alumnus has the right to access the library after obtaining an alumni card. I think it is reasonable to charge a small annual fee to build this system. Because the number of alumni is large, the funds gathered will inevitably be huge, enough to pay for these books. Moreover, this is not just a library construction initiative; more importantly, it also helps improve the university's global indicators. Because when alumni can access more books, it also means that more books will be spread to their countries. This is a very meaningful initiative, and I think every alumnus would be willing to contribute this small and reasonable amount of money.

The subsequent development of this initiative could even attract charitable foundations, which I believe is possible. In the future, an alumni book network could be established, allowing alumni from around the world to contribute excellent books from their respective countries. With this development, the University of Southampton's library could potentially become a leading global library, breaking academic regional barriers. By then, the reputation of our university would certainly be even more renowned worldwide.

The above are just my humble opinions as a student who deeply loves the University of Southampton. I look forward to you seriously considering these suggestions and responding.

Best regards,
Yufei Tang